

Rolando Daniel Vela

Software Engineer | AI and Machine Learning

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University <i>Master of Science in Computer Science</i>	Evanston, IL Anticipated June 2029
Northwestern University <i>Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering & AI</i>	Evanston, IL Anticipated June 2029

SKILLS

Technical: AutoCAD, Autodesk Inventor, Onshape, 3D Printing, Machining (CNC, Mill, Lathe), Prototyping
Software: MATLAB, Python, Java, JavaScript, Vscode, Office 365, Adobe Suite

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder & CEO <i>Versed</i>	Chicago, IL 2025 – Present
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- Co-founded and serve as CEO of Versed, leading a 7-person cross-functional team building Xpyre, a mobile-first tool that decodes manufacturer expiration-date codes for beverage-warehouse staff to prevent loss
- Directed the product from concept to active pilot with a regional distributor, overseeing full-stack web development, customer discovery, and product roadmap
- Outgoing funding requests from a16z, Sequoia Capital, and Accel, with message of interest from Y Combinator

Founder of InternetWear <i>Online Company Management</i>	Laredo, TX June 2022 – Present
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- Founded and scaled a multi-channel e-commerce enterprise to \$65k in revenue with 50%+ profit margins, conducting data-driven market analysis to identify niche trends
- Designed proprietary products using Adobe Creative Suite and drove customer acquisition through social media marketing, achieving an 8% ad click-through rate
- Engineered a lean, automated supply chain architecture to manage end-to-end fulfillment across eBay, Walmart, and Etsy, optimizing the pipeline from digital order to final delivery
- Managed monthly P&L reporting, tax compliance, and margin analysis, leveraging data analytics to sustain profitability through the business's scale-up

Powell Watson Motors Inc. <i>Intern – Backend Network Development and AI Integration</i>	Laredo, TX June 2026 – September 2026
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- Maintained enterprise LAN infrastructure and network endpoints to ensure localized connectivity
- Deployed an AI chatbot streamlining the vehicle-selection pipeline, boosting customer completion rates by 30%
- Designed and deployed NFC-enabled WiFi and review-prompt signage across 3 locations, driving ~100 daily scans and a 4.5-star Google location rating

Limitless Learning Education and Tutoring Center — AP Tutor	June 2024 – September 2024
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PROJECT EXPERIENCE

IBM SkillsBuild AI Builders Challenge Retrieval-Augmented Commentary Engine	June 2026
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- Programmed FIFADEx, a multistage AI pipeline on FastAPI that uses Docling AI for video transcription and IBM Granite (via Watsonx.ai) to cross-reference commentary, mapping data into a gamified learning dashboard
- Presented FIFADEx at the IBM SkillsBuild AI Builders Challenge as part of a 5-person team

Northwestern Rocketry Club Transonic Aerostructure Design & Fabrication	September 2025 – Present
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- Designed tapered swept fin geometries using Onshape CAD software to optimize aerodynamic stability and minimize wave drag for a competition rocket targeting a 12,000-foot apogee and transonic flight profiles
- Manufactured precision aluminum and carbon-fiber components via Onshape CAM/CNC to meet load specs

LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

Lambda Upsilon Lambda Fraternity, Inc. — Council Relations Chair	December 2025 – Present
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ASME Robotics — Mechanical Design Lead	Fall 2025 – Present
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Awards: Jane Street Focus Participant, Greenwood Fintech Academy Fellow, and HSF Scholar